

What is a prototype?

In other design fields a prototype is a small-scale model:

- a miniature car
- a miniature building or town
- the examples here come from a 3D printer



Figure 11.1 (a) Color output from a 3D printer: all the gears and rods in this model were 'printed' in one pass from bottom to top, and when one gear is turned, the others turn too. (a)
Source: (a) The Computer Language Company, Inc., courtesy of Alan Freedman



(c)

(c) A teddy bear 'printed' from a wireframe

design <http://www.disneyresearch.com/project/printed-teddy-bears/>

(c) Courtesy of Scott Hudson, Human-Computer Interaction Institute, Carnegie Mellon University.

What is a prototype?

In interaction design it can be (among other things):

- a series of screen sketches
- a storyboard, i.e. a cartoon-like series of scenes
- a Powerpoint slide show
- **a video simulating the use of a system**
- a lump of wood (e.g. PalmPilot)
- a cardboard mock-up
- **a piece of software with limited functionality written in the target language or in another language**